

Poster Sessions

Full-paper and summary posters are displayed on Tuesday, August 18, 2026, with poster-presentation slots during the morning and afternoon coffee breaks. Selected late-breaking abstracts are also displayed with the Tuesday posters and are listed separately below. One full-paper poster is displayed on Thursday, August 20, 2026. Late-breaking abstract posters are also displayed on Thursday, with presentation slots during the morning and afternoon coffee breaks.

Legend: unmarked = full paper; * = summary; † = journal talk.

Tuesday Posters of Full Papers and Summaries

1. *Weaving Cellular Automata: Open-Endedness and Creativity through Hybridising Computation*
Pei-Ying Lin; Alyssa Adams; Femke Vorselen; Kristina Andersen; Olaf Witkowski
2. *The Varieties of Schelling Model Experience**
Jesse Anttila-Hughes; Alan O. Jamison; Marlyn Mwita; Timothy Sorochkin
3. *Curiosity-Driven Exploration Discovers Diverse Protein–Ligand Interaction Profiles Across Protein Families*
Zacharie Bugaud
4. *A New Grounding For (M,R) Systems*
Marcelo Segura-Lepe; Juan-Carlos Letelier
5. *Prediction and Entropy of Evolving Sequences: A Transformer-Based Estimator of Functional Information*
Tyler D. Myers; Se Jin Song; Andrew Bartko
6. *Toward Digital Twins for Fungal Computing: A Simulation Study of Viable XOR Regimes, Parameter Identifiability, and Waveform-Guided Calibration*
Kiran Bhattacharyya
7. *Democracy on Rugged Landscapes: Phase Transitions in Optimal Voting Rules*
Joshua Nunley
8. *Artificial Societies and Ecological Collapse: an LLM-enhanced Agent-Based Model of a Sustainability Game**
Francesco Bertolotti
9. *Rest In Privacy: Deathbots, Dignity, and the Case for Regulation*
Sophie Mutch
10. *Counteracting host reactions to synthetic reprogramming in animal forms of artificial life*
Ithai Rabinowitch; Leonardo Bich; Andrea Roli; Elio Tuci
11. *Proxy Exploitation in a Minimal Signaling Ecology: How Confounded Evaluation Creates and Redistributes Exploitation Regimes*
Ziwei Ma
12. *BraiNCA: brain-inspired neural cellular automata and applications to morphogenesis and motor control*
Léo Pio-Lopez; Benedikt Hartl; Michael Levin
13. *Expanding the Mathematical Foundations of Artificial Life: A Systematic Search Across Function Families, Geometries, and Open Expressions in Lenia*
Zhe Hong; Mingyang Song
14. *Coordination Under Existential Unawareness: Information Ablation and Closure Thresholds in LLM Multi-Agent Systems*
Hao Ke; Jingyun Wu
15. *OpenLife: Toward Open-World Artificial Life with Autonomous LLM Agents*
Atsushi Masumori; Itsuki Doi; Norihiro Maruyama
16. *Emergent Culture in Minimal LLM Systems*
Simon Jones; Sabine Hauert
17. *Topology That Learns: Investigating Mycelial and Physarum Networks as a Conceptual Blueprint for Streaming Time Series Prediction*
Hollister Cutler; Chih-Hung Li
18. *Observer-Based Pattern Discovery on Frozen Histories*
Sebastian von Mammen; Tobias Buhl
19. *Emergence of Social Reasoning through Adaptive Evolution of LLMs*
Takumi Hara; Takaya Arita; Reiji Suzuki
20. *Investigating Nintendo Family Computer Bugs: How Hardware-Level Perturbations Shape Software Behavior*
Qingyao Huang; Yongbo Zhang; Shun Ota; Tomoyuki Kubota; Kohei Nakajima
21. *Per-Node Activation Function Evolution in Indirectly Encoded Substrates: Solvability, Limits and Emergent Diversity*
Romain Claret; Michael O’Neill; Paul Cotofrei; Kilian Stoffel
22. *CheeseBench: Evaluating Large Language Models on Rodent Behavioral Neuroscience Paradigms*
Zacharie Bugaud
23. *Self-Modifying Linear Genetic Programming*
Zachary Perrico; Wolfgang Banzhaf

24. *From Signals to Structure: How Memory Architecture Drives Language Emergence in LLM Agents*
Yashar Talebirad; Eden Redman; Ali Parsaee; Osmar R. Zaiane
25. *ZKWorm: Attesting Whole-Brain C. elegans Dynamics on Blockchain Substrate with Zero-Knowledge Proofs*
Louis Parker; Robert Clarke
26. *Phylogenetically-mixed Agent Architectures*
Bradly Alicea
27. *The Informationally Integrated Alignment Hypothesis: Integrated Information Aligns with and Predicts Final Reward in Reinforcement Learning Agents*
Federico Pigozzi; Michael Levin
28. *Towards an Open Interactive Real-Time Platform for Connectome-Driven Behavioral Simulation of C. elegans*
Felix Fink; Philip Kollmannsberger; Simon Stöckl; Sarah Wolpold; Marie Holfelder; Sebastian von Mammen; Christian Stigloher; Thomas Dandekar
29. *Grounded Imagination Leads to Adaptation*
Judah Goldfeder

30. *Evolutionary learning in dimerization networks*[~]
Bortolo Moggetti; Sergei Maslov; Alexei Tkachenko
31. *Onset of natural selection and catalytic function in prebiotic information-coding polymers*^{*}
Sergei Maslov; Alexei Tkachenko
32. *Intrinsic behavioral dispositions shape the dynamical complexity of opinion evolution in adaptive social networks*^{*}
Hiroki Sayama; Akshay Gangadhar
33. *Is Complexity an Illusion?*^{*}
Michael Timothy Bennett
34. *Are Biological Systems More Intelligent Than Artificial Intelligence?*^{*}
Michael Timothy Bennett
35. *Dreaming Itself: Diffusion Models as the Structural Substrate for Self-Awareness in Humanoid Robots*
Xining Li
36. *Replication of Kauffman (1969): Metabolic Stability and Epigenesis in Randomly Constructed Genetic Nets*
Gaetano Rispoli

Tuesday Posters for Late-Breaking Abstracts

These late-breaking abstracts are presented with the Tuesday poster session.

39. *8-Bit Fluids*
Erik Buehler
40. *Pixel-Space Diffusion with Neural Cellular Automata*
Eric Gericke; Martin Schüle
41. *The Selective Pressure for Evolvability in Lexicase Selection*
Karen Suzue; Charles Ofria

Thursday Posters for Full Papers

1. *HybridDenseFormer for Serotonergic Neurochemical Mapping from Multimodal MRI*
Morteza Esmaeili

Thursday Late-Breaking Abstract Posters

1. *Archive Memory as a Reconstructible Recovery Code in Deep Quality-Diversity Search*
Takayuki Hasui
2. *1-Bit Fluids*
Erik Buehler

3. *Local and Dyadic Interactions Enrich Evolutionary Dynamics in Structural Cellular Hash Chemistry*
Hiroki Sayama
4. *PRIMITIVE BREATH: Subjective Interpretation through Observation of Life-likeness Phenomena in a WebAL Environment*
Sakae Kudo
5. *Biomaterial habitats and self-replicating systems beyond Earth*
Robin Wordsworth; Rafid Quayum; Elida Kocharian; Ann Pearson; Xavier Portillo; Madeleine Yang; Charles Cockell; George Church; Shannon Nangle
6. *Evolving Competitive Nanomagnetic Creatures*
Arthur Penty; Gunnar Tufte
7. *Facultative Self-Reproduction in Quine, a Process-Native LLM Medium*
Hao Ke; Jingyun Wu
8. *Individuation without Objectives: Identity from Developmental History in a Non-Scoring Field Substrate*
Cyan Lynn Yun
9. *Five Measures of Emergent Complexity Across Thirteen Artificial Life Systems*
Joel Dietz
10. *The Cybernetic-Informational Chemoton: a new metatheoretical synthesis*
Hans Contreras-Pulache
11. *Structural Elicitation in a Frozen POSIX Agent: Environmental Affordance Fields for Artificial Agency*
Hao Ke; Jingyun Wu
12. *Survival Selection Grows a Private Kin Code, Not a Public Language*
Chunxuan Yang
13. *A Tumor in the Repository: Function-Decoupled Self-Maintenance in an LLM-Agent Substrate*
Hao Ke
14. *Critical Order-Parameter Cognition: Emergent Affect in a Self-Tuning Oscillator System*
Linga Murthy Narlagiri
15. *From Simple Chemistry to Complex Dynamics: A New Excitable Active Liquid System*
Radim Ivanovič; Małgorzata Mrozik; Jitka Čejková
16. *Exploring the Fitness Landscape Properties of Evolved Virtual Creatures*
Siliang Song
17. *Bacterial Agency Constrains Genomic Engineering*
David G. Watters
18. *Distinguishing Preference from Expansion: a Consumer-grade Morphometric Time-series in Physarum Polycephalum*
Ahilinie Nanthakumar
19. *How Might a Bimodal Albedo Distribution Evolve in 1D Daisyworld?*
Georgii Karelin
20. *TEMOCHIMORI: Expressing Live Heart Rate through a Living Kokedama*
Satoshi Nakagawa; Darey-Ann Louisville; Reki Ueda; Kodai Masamitsu; Misato Nihei
21. *Genesis: An Empirical Platform for Studying Open-Ended Evolution Without Fitness Function*
Anushka Sharma
22. *Grown, not trained: what a developmental map makes likely before selection*
Sergii Medvid; Mykola Glybovets
23. *Emergence of Social Behaviour Without Built-in Sociality Among Independent, Embodied Foragers: A Configurable Multi-Agent Platform*
Justin P. Ma; Tyler R. Bonnell
24. *Morphological Computation: An Operator Framework for Wetting and Photonic Transduction in Beetle Elytra*
Spas Kerimov; Georgi Yankov; Radouane Oudrhiri; Ekaterina Iordanova
25. *Growing an Affect-First Agent: Developmental Loops in a Persistent Emotional System*
Hochul Han
26. *Urban Growth Patterns Emerging from a Physarum-Solver Model Coupled with Population Dynamics*
Taishi Mikami; Seiji Takagi; Takeshi Kano
27. *Emergence of Feature-Based Discrimination in a Non-Episodic Evolutionary Foraging Model*
Migara Kumarasinghe
28. *Fitness landscape topology determines evolutionary hotspot location in spatially heterogeneous population structures*
Clifford Bohm; Grant Gordon; Austin J. Ferguson; Alexander Lalejini
29. *MorphoGraph: A Developmental Encoding for Modular, Evolvable Animal Body Plans*
Sean Hardy
30. *Limbomorphs*
Alex Alvarez; Michael Levin

31. *Growing with the Task: Ontogenetic Scaling in Adaptive Reservoirs*
Siddharth Chaturvedi; Ahmed El-Gazzar; Marcel van Gerven
32. *Transformational Novelty with an Automata Meta-Chemistry*
Alyssa M. Adams; Celia Blanco; Valerii Chirkov; Kathrin Korte; Eric Medvet; Eleni Nisioti; Sidney Pontes-Filho; Susan Stepney; Paul Templier
33. *Self-Fulfilling Expectations in Evolutionary Games*
Nathan Lloyd; Peter R. Lewis
34. *From Uncertainty to Apparent Conviction: Epistemic Dynamics in Artificial Conversational Agents*
Zahra Atf; Peter R. Lewis
35. *The Override Is the Product: Sexualized coercive control as the new architecture of AI jailbreaking*
Acacia L. Ackles; Elliott Whitson
36. *From Coordination to Correction: Proto-Normative Feedback in LLM Agent Societies*
Zahra Atf; Peter R. Lewis
37. *Winnower: Inferring Periodic Domains in Cellular Automata*
Joshua Herman
38. *Self-organized Boolean computation*
Iliya Zhechev; Piotr Walas
39. *Causal Architecture Dynamics Prior to Arrival of Self-replicators in a Bio-realistic Model of Life's Origins*
Federico Pigozzi; Michael Levin
40. *Morphogenesis Through Synchronization: A Kuramoto Neural Cellular Automaton*
Antonia Antonova
41. *Classification by Class-State Attractors*
Krsto Proroković
42. *Structural Selectivity and Learned Hyperbolic Geometry in Pancreas, Bone Marrow, and Thymus Gene Regulatory and Protein Interaction Knowledge Graphs*
Amangel Bhullar; Ziad Kobti
43. *Memory Is Communication: The Frontier Between Remembering and Signaling*
Yashar Talebirad; Eden Redman; Ali Parsaee; Osmar R. Zaiane
44. *BrainlessLab: from cellular cognition to collective intelligence*
Ben Gaskin; Polyphony Bruna; Ian Jackson; William O'Hearn
45. *Geometry, Memory, and Quantum-Like Dynamics in Cellular Automata*
Yashine H. Goolam Hossen; Matthew Zullo; Lea Gassab; Travis J. A. Craddock